GLOBAL MUSIC MARKET & GENRE TRENDS

Where should a UK artist test a release abroad?

I used Spotify Top 200 genre profiles to shortlist territories for UK Rock / Alternative and Electronic / Dance releases. Each candidate pairs genre demand with similarity to the UK's overall chart mix.

65	52	5
Comparable 2021 markets	Balanced trend markets	Market clusters

Rock / Alternative

	Genre share	UK similarity
Lithuania	19.39%	0.981
Australia	12.08%	0.993

Electronic / Dance

	Genre share	UK similarity
Netherlands	13.14%	0.983
Belgium	12.26%	0.990

HOW I WOULD USE THE SHORTLIST

Check the artist's own listeners, local partners, and campaign costs. Run a small release pilot with predefined save rate, repeat listening, and cost per incremental listener.

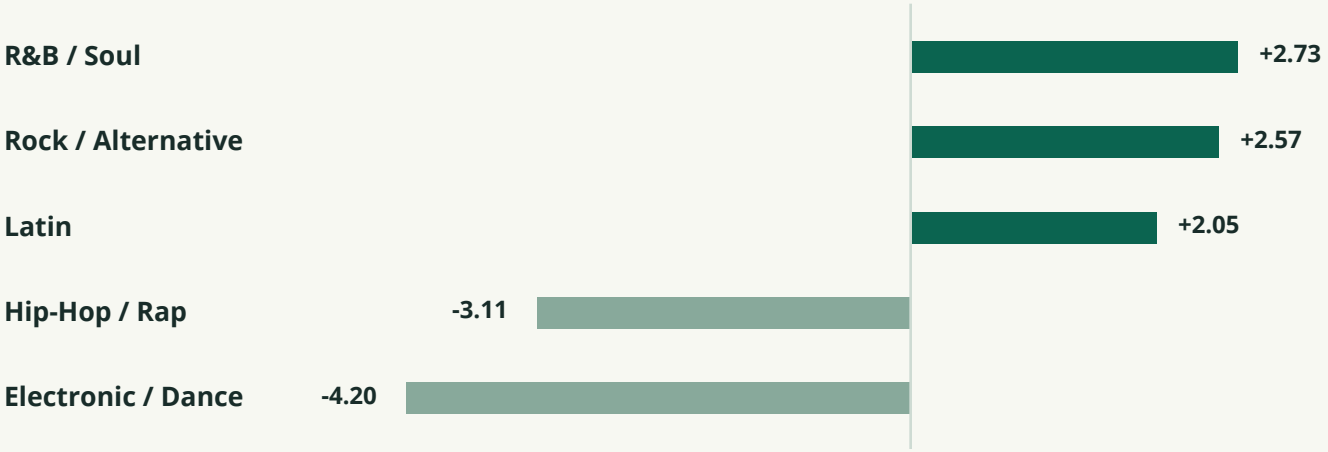
GENRE REACH & MOMENTUM

Genre share tells two stories

Pop accounted for at least 5% of classified chart streams in all 65 markets. Latin crossed that mark in 16, while Brazilian genres crossed it in two. A genre can have a strong home market and limited reach elsewhere.

Change in average genre share, 2018–2021

Percentage points across 52 balanced markets



Local shifts can be much larger

Hip-Hop / Rap gained 32.68 percentage points in Greece and 22.15 in Poland. Rock / Alternative gained 16.10 in Thailand. Those are changes in share of charted streams. Absolute streams could move differently.

A DIFFERENT SIGNAL: LOCAL AFFINITY

Japan's Soundtrack / Anime share was 18.44%, around 44 times the average market share. That flags a local preference worth investigating alongside absolute volume.

METHODS & VALIDATION

How I compared markets

Create comparable samples

The original pipeline reported 21.26M raw chart rows, 2,000 duplicate rows removed, and zero unmatched song rows. For 2021 I used 65 regional markets with all 12 months present. For the trend I used 52 with all 48 months present from 2018 through 2021.

Calculate share, affinity and similarity

Genre share divides each genre's chart streams by classified chart streams, excluding Unknown and Other. Affinity divides a territory's share by the unweighted market mean. UK similarity uses cosine similarity across all 17 genre shares.

Use clusters to organize campaign planning

I compared K-Means solutions from k=2 to k=8. The k=2 solution scored highest on silhouette (0.530). I chose k=5 (0.521) for more detail and treated the Brazil-only cluster as an outlier. The verification script reproduced the exported assignments.

Keep the decision at artist level

The analysis covers historical Top 200 activity. Chart coverage, artist metadata and genre-family rules affect comparisons. The figures help screen markets for research and small tests. They do not establish artist demand or forecast campaign returns.

DATA SOURCE

MGD+ · Seufitelli, Oliveira, Silva & Moro · Zenodo